rejection of a sovereign Jewish state based on the notion of ethnic peoplehood and active sympathy for the alleged victims of such a state's "oppressive" power. Hence the aggressive feelings focused obsessively on Israel find their source and justification in the cosmopolitan ideals of universal values and human rights. In an essay entitled "How to Become an Anti-Zionist," the Italian philosopher and former member of the European Parliament Gianni Vattimo advocates a progressive politics built on these values that he calls, proudly, if absurdly, "Democratic anti-Zionism." It sees Israel's establishment as an "irredeemable sin," one of "the harms produced by Hitler's politics and by the Holocaust," and wants to do away with the Jewish state as such.[13] Calling this eliminationist program "Democratic anti-Zionism" enables those who subscribe to it to do so in good conscience, convinced that virtue is on their side and victory will soon be theirs. Thus Omar Barghouti is certain that "we are witnessing the rapid demise of Zionism, and nothing can be done to save it." He then triumphantly proclaims, "I, for one, support euthanasia."[14] Many others join him in entertaining such a death wish. They are working hard to bring about its fulfilment.

What is shaping up here is by now pretty clear: under the deceptive rubric "criticism of Israel," self-approving narcissism comes together with self-affirming virtue and, for extra measure, adds generous doses of guilt and recrimination associated with references to the Holocaust, and the result is a reenergized and newly popular strain of anti-Zionism. At its deepest level, this anti-Zionism embodies a personal desire and political wish that Sarfati sums up in words that ring disturbingly true: "Anti-Zionism prepares…the death of the Jewish state."[15] To those who feel its power, there is something intoxicating about this murderous fantasy. It is unlikely to disappear any time soon.

NOTES

1. Judith Butler, *Parting Ways: Jewishness and the Critique of Zionism* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2102), 1.
2. Andrei S. Markovits *Uncouth Nation* (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press, 2007), xiii–xiv.
3. A petition was created that drew over 184,000 signatories asking for officials at Tel Aviv University, where he studied, to expel Omar Barghouti, but he was not expelled; http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Omar_Barghouti#cite_note-3.
4. Following student complaints, the Council did look into charges about the politicization of the Political Science Department at Ben-Gurion University of the Negev in Beersheva, but no action was taken to fire any of its faculty members or close the department.

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